

probably still do well. But if you have only a three-month time horizon, anything can happen.

Why did you think there was a three-month time horizon?

Because I started doubting whether I would continue.

Did you close the fund?

I did. I closed it at the end of the first year.

What finally prompted you to close the fund?

I had talked to my friends about how I felt. Rohm & Haas heard that I was unhappy being on my own and offered me a job. I decided to take the offer and close my fund.

How did you feel when you closed the fund?

Here was the most startling thing for me. I got the offer letter from Rohm & Haas around Christmastime. I'll never forget the sinking feeling I had when I read the letter. It was an offer to be regional director of Asia based in Hong Kong. I really had no desire to go to Asia.

Hadn't you discussed the details of your job before accepting the offer to come back?

I hadn't up to that point. They had basically said they would bring me back into a key job and that I would possibly still be in line to become CEO of Rohm & Haas. Basically, they desperately needed someone good in Asia. No one else who was qualified wanted to go. Their attitude was *Tom wants to come back. Perfect. He has to earn his way back, and we'll send him to Asia. It will be well perceived by the organization.* For them it was very clear.

I walked out to put the *for sale* sign in front of my house, and I just couldn't do it. One of my sons was a great gymnast; he was a state champion. So one of my concerns was: Where would my kids do their athletics? I had this terrible feeling about it. So I called the CEO of Rohm & Haas and said, "Do you mind if I go to Hong Kong and check it out first?" He said, "Sure, go to Hong Kong."

When I was at the airport in line for the flight, I was still not sure that I wanted to go. So I got out of line. Then I got back in line, and then back